St. Noah's Cathedral on the Water

By Corey Clancy

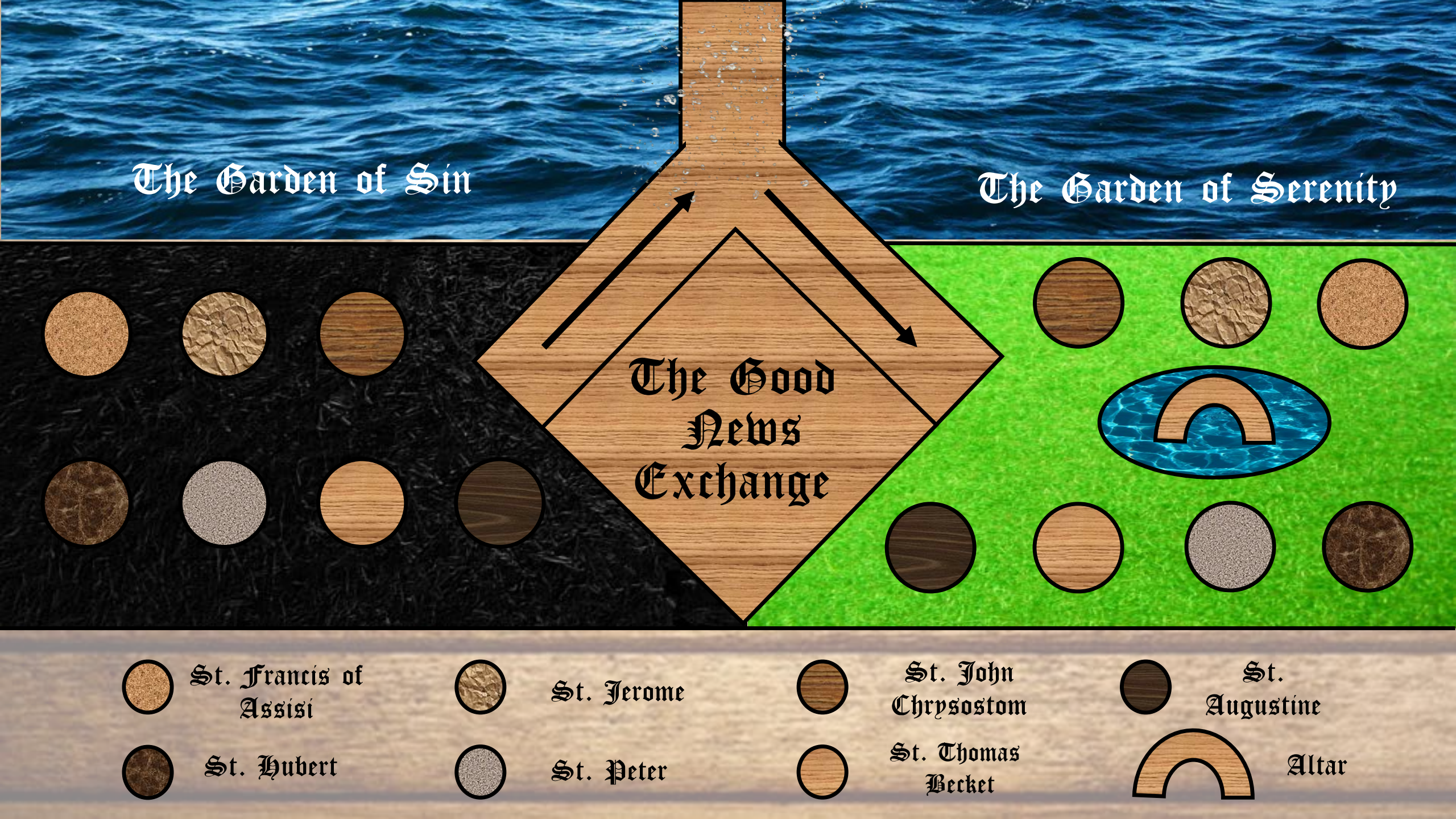
The Story of Noah's Ark

Due to the wickedness of Adam and Eve and their descendants, God decided that He needed to wipe out the Earth and start anew. Therefore, he reached out to the one man on Earth who remained obedient to Him, Noah. He requested that Noah build a big boat, an ark, that was 450 feet long, 75 feet wide, and 45 feet high with three floors. Furthermore, Noah was tasked with finding a male and a female of every single animal on Earth to be taken into the ark. After 120 years and at the age of 600, Noah had completed the ark. God allowed him to bring the selected animals as well as his family, including his wife, his three sons named Japheth, Ham, and Shem, and their wives, onto the boat. For forty days and forty nights it rained, and for quite a while it remained flooded. After the flood seemed to be stopping, Noah released a dove into the air to see if it would spot any land. The dove came back without finding any land, so after seven additional days, Noah sent the dove back out again. It returned with an olive leaf, signifying to Noah that the flood had ended, and land had been found. Noah docked on land, stepped off the boat, built an alar that he had promised to God, and witnessed the first rainbow, which represented God's promise to never destroy the earth by flooding it again!

The Story of the St. Noah's Cathedral on The Water

Heavily inspired by Noah's Ark, St. Noah's Cathedral on the Water will be a three-story tall stationary boat on the water, with the first floor being the Sacristy for the priest and storage, the second floor including the main Church space as well as two decks for Church-related activities, and the third floor being an Adoration chapel! The bottom floor on the outside of the boat will have a mural of the animals that were taken onto the Ark in the original story, and the middle floor on the outside of the boat will have a beautiful, brown, wooden door similar to the one in the picture to the right as well as two stained glass circular images of a dove and a sun close to the top of the level. Finally, the third level will be made completely out of rainbow-stained glass in order to represent the rainbow that appeared at the end of the flood. In order to get on the boat, one must first enter through the Garden of Sin, representing the wicked world one is leaving behind in order to get onto the boat and be redeemed. As you make your way up the boat, a light mist of holy water will purify you! Once the Church service is over, one will exit the boat by entering the Garden of Serenity, representing the new world created after the flood. In between these gardens will be the Good News Exchange, a giftshop for all visitors!




The Garden of Sin
The Garden of Serenity
The Good News Exchange
St. Francis of Assisi
St. Jerome
St. John Chrysostom
St. Augustine
St. Hubert
St. Peter
St. Thomas Becket
Altar

The Garden of Sin



Photographer: SGPhoto



Photographer: Amy Kristin



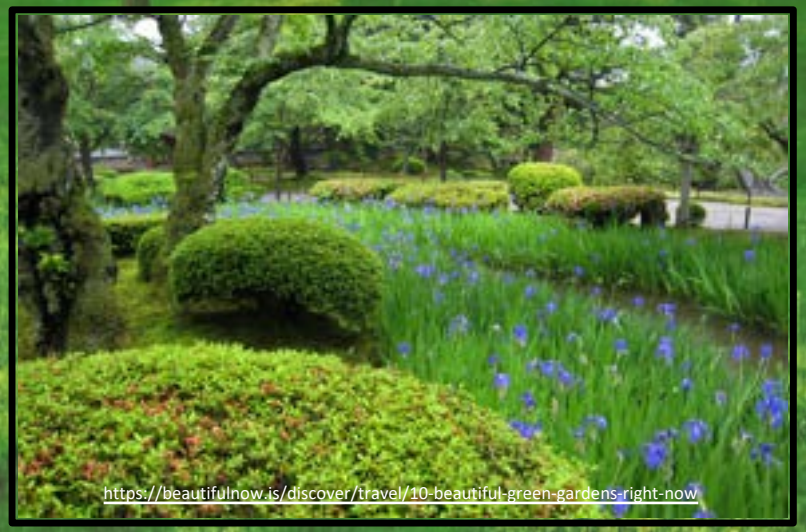
Photographer: Daria Nipot

To enter St. Noah's Ark, you first must enter through the Garden of Sin. As you walk through this garden, you will notice it is dark and ominous. You can look around and see black trees, some of which have remnants of being burnt down. The ground is brown and dusty as well as full of dirt, bushes turning brown, twigs and sticks, and old leaves. It smells as though there has just been a fire, and there are smells of rotting dead animal carcasses. You pass by seven statues reminiscent of seven different saints who have had sinful pasts but also have a connection to different animals. First, you pass a black statue of a wolf, lamb, and bird to remind you of St. Francis of Assisi, who grew up in excessive wealth. To the right of him you will find a black statue of a deer that is representative of St. Hubert who was scorned upon for his disloyalty to family. Directly behind this statue is a statue of a black rooster that is meant to be a reminder of St. Peter, who denied Jesus three times. To the left of this statue is one of a black lion that is symbolic of St. Jerome, a sex addict. Behind this statue you will find a stature of a black beehive, reminiscent of St. John Chrysostom, who had been accused of abusing the law. To the right of this statue is one that has three black Cornish choughs to represent St Thomas Becket, a saint who suffered from extreme greed. Finally, behind this statue is one of a black dove to represent St. Augustine, who was known for extreme sexual misconduct. There are seven different statues to draw attention to the importance of the number seven meaning "perfection."

While these saints seem imperfect, after you have cleansed yourself through Church on the boat, you will realize just how perfect they became when you come off the boat and enter the Garden of Serenity. This garden is very bright, full of lush, green trees, bright green grass, smells of fresh waterfalls, and beautiful flowers. The same statues that were in the Garden of Sin can be found in the Garden of Serenity, but instead they are topiaries made of flowers. This represents that just as these saints found God, so did you after you went to Church on the boat. You have escaped the Garden of Sin and joined the Garden of Serenity!


https://wallpapersafari.com/w/lhULT6


http://www.holemanlandscape.com/2015/06/26/do-you-really-like-mowing/


https://beautifulnow.is/discover/travel/10-beautiful-green-gardens-right-now

The Garden of Serenity

In the middle of the Garden of Serenity, there will be an altar to God, representing the altar that Noah built at the end of the flood in order to praise God. The altar will be a wooden one with the shape and colors of a rainbow, and it will be surrounded by a pond of water! This altar will be of the rainbow shape to represent God's promise to never wipe mankind out with a flood again!



https://www.finegardening.com/article/a-relaxing-water-



https://www.houzz.com.sg/photos/ecosystem-pond-maintenace-spring-pond-or-water-garden-maintenance-tips-phvw-vp~8328146



https://platinumprophouse.com/products/rainbow-table



https://www.trendhunter.com/trends/like-a-rainbow

The Garden of Serenity

St. Francis of Assisi


https://azum.ua/en/product/statuetka-volk-2423-sm


https://www.furniturefactoryusa.com/collections/accessories/products/baa-baa-sheep-statue


https://creativeartworksblog.wordpress.com/2022/03/08/tremendous-topiary/


https://www.designboom.com/art/living-plant-sculptures-at-the-montreal-botanical-gardens/


https://huitaicraft.en.alibaba.com/product/6231458211-814234071/Custom_design_life_like_black_bird_figurine_resin_raven_statue_black_crow_garden_decor_realistic_ravern_resin_crow_.html

Sin: Greed and Wealth
Redemption: Gave His Things Away
Animals: Many, Including Wolf, Sheep, and Bird


https://wcep.com/product/howl-wolf-topiary/

The Garden of Sin

The Garden of Serenity

St. Peter

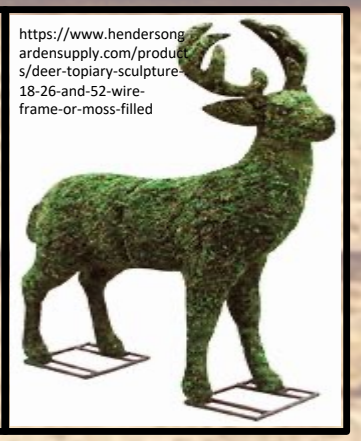




Sin: Denied Jesus 3 times
Redemption: Found the First Church
Animal: Rooster

St. Hubert

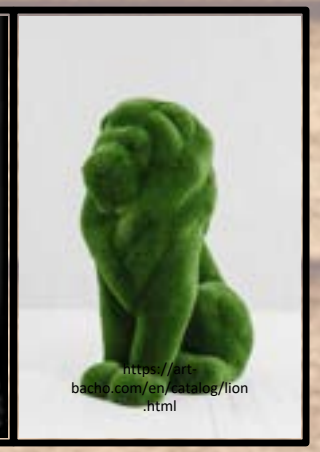




Sin: Disloyalty to Family
Redemption: Converted Pagans to Christianity
Animal: Stag

St. Jerome





Sin: Sexual Misconduct
Redemption: Became a Theologian
Animal: Lion

St. Augustine





Sin: Sexual Misconduct
Redemption: Became a Priest and Evangelized
Animal: A Dove

St. John Chrystosom





Sin: Abuse of Law
Redemption: Became Archbishop of Constantinople
Animal: A Beehive/Bee

St. Thomas Becket

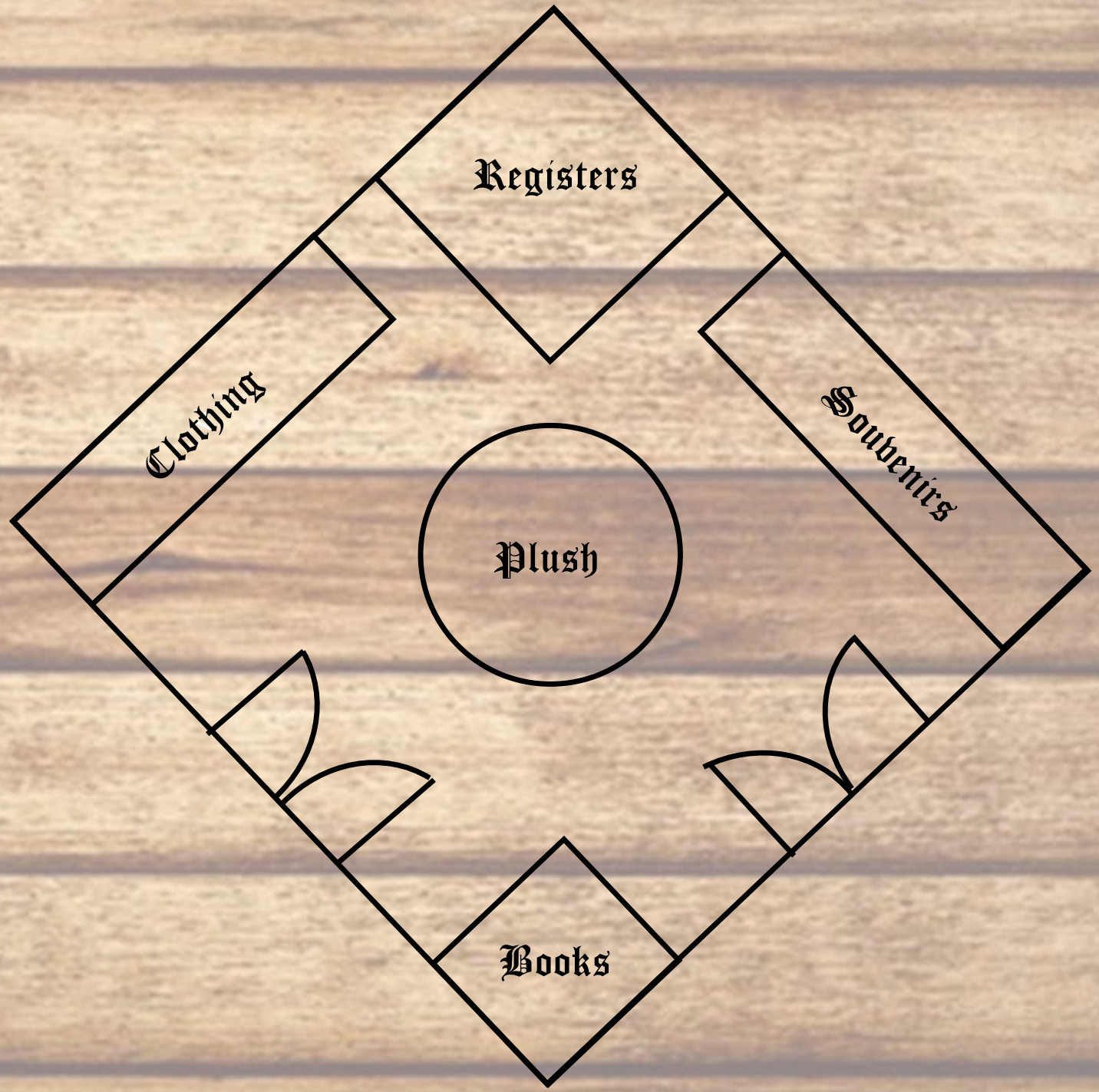




Sin: Greed and Wealth
Redemption: Became Archbishop of Canterbury
Animal: 3 Cornish Choughs

The Good News Exchange

The Good News Exchange will be a relatively simple design. It will be as tall as the first floor of the boat is but no taller so as not to block much more of the view of the boat. Inside, it will be extremely wooden with wooden crates and tables holding everything. Similarly, hay and pieces of grass and leaves will be all over the floor. It should almost feel like a market in the desert transported to an inside gift shop. Clothing, plush stuffed animals, books, and other souvenirs like figurines will be sold inside of the shop!

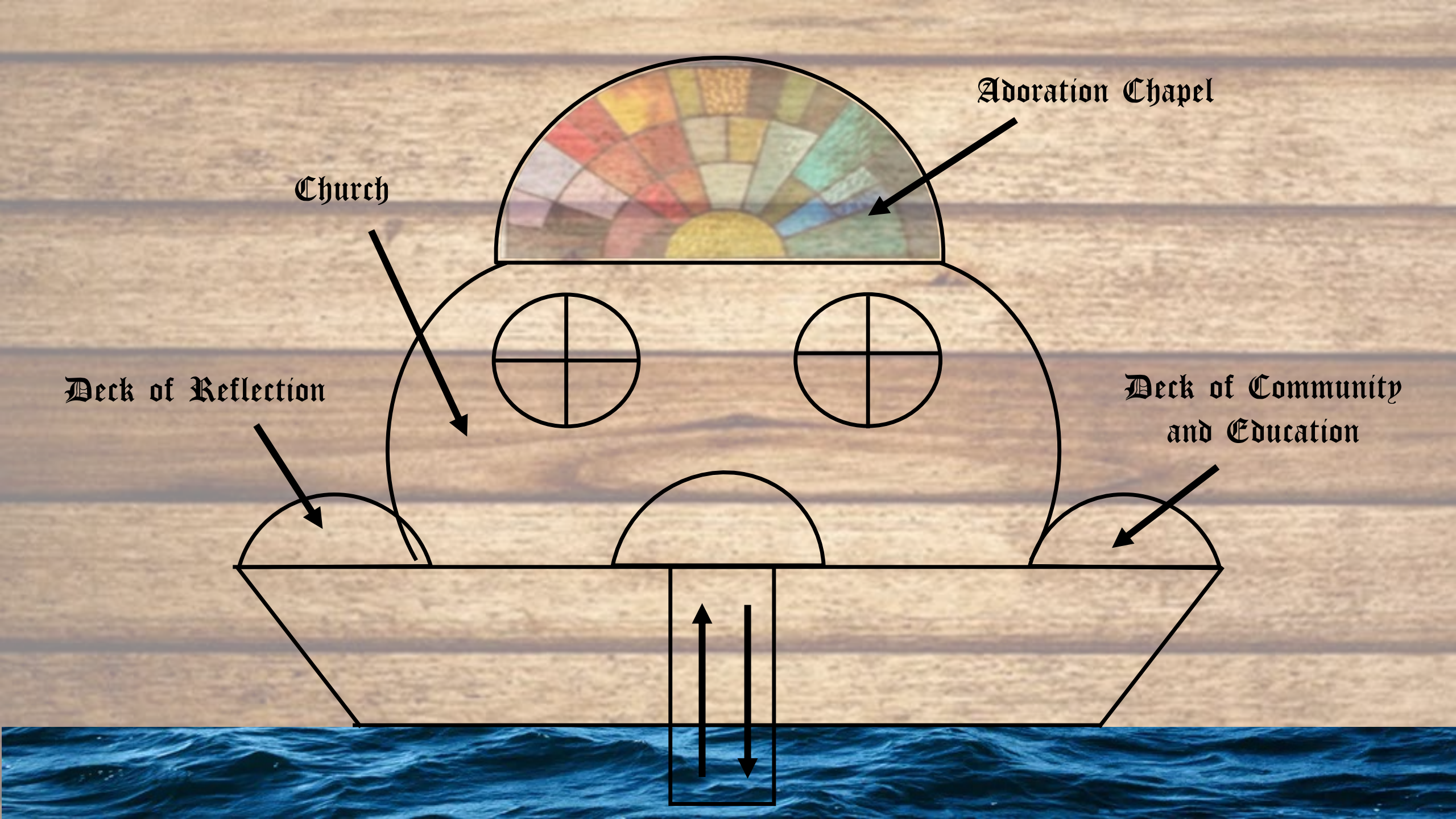


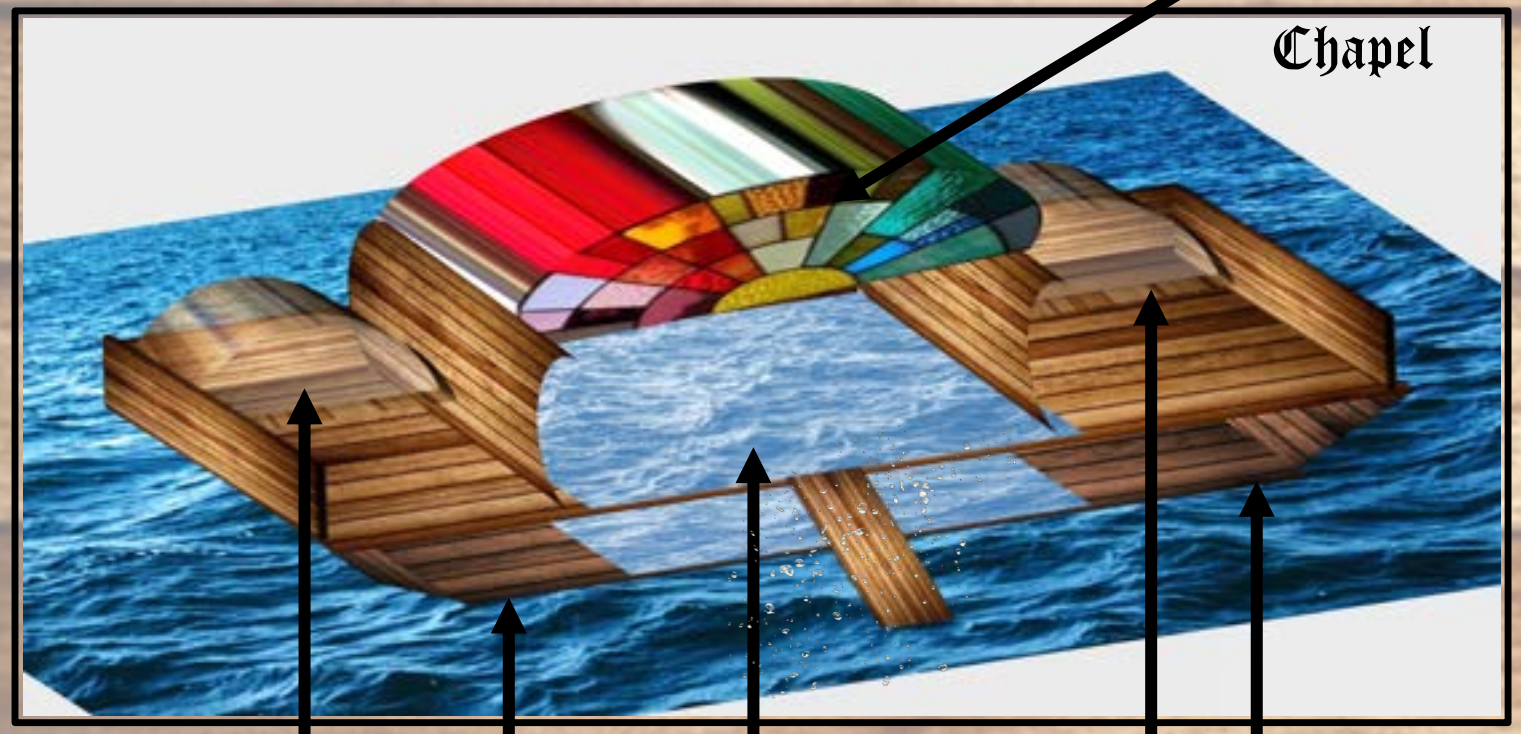
The Good News Exchange


https://arkencounter.com/gift-shop/


https://arkencounter.com/gift-shop/


https://arkencounter.com/gift-shop/


Adoration Chapel
Church
Deck of Reflection
Deck of Community
and Education



Important Notes

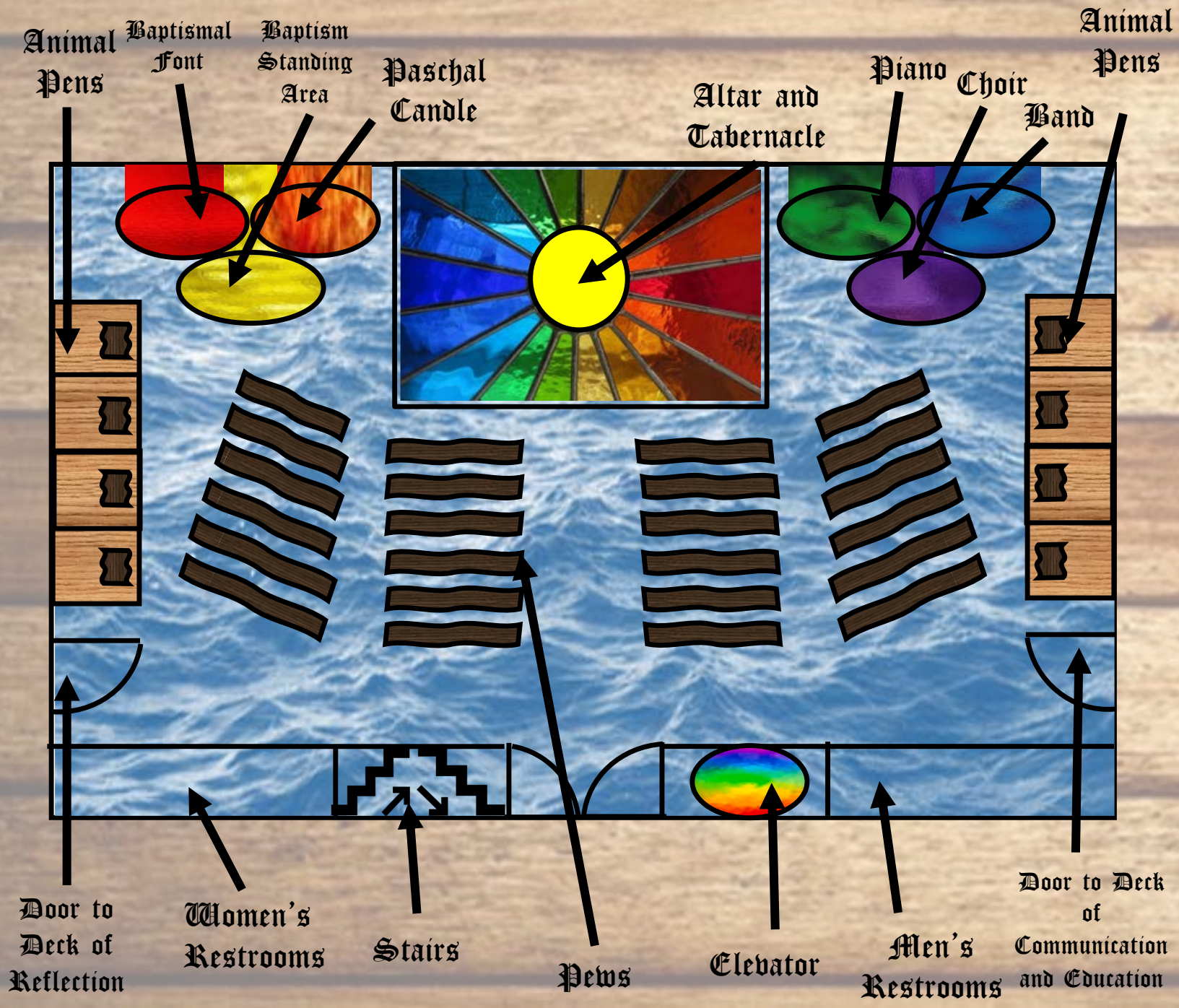
Confessional Room on the Deck of Reflection: Animal pens around the room will serve as confessional stalls, and the Stations of the Cross will be around the perimeter of the room in the form of statues The wall facing out to the deck will be glass.

See-Through Floor: The floor of the Church's main room will be see-through glass in order to give the illusion of Jesus walking on water. The bottom floor beneath the Church's main room will also have to be see through for this effect.

Education Room on the Deck of Community and Education: This room will be barren, as it is supposed to allow for a lot of different activities, including RCIA class, Sacrament education, and Church meals. Tables in the storage of the Church can be moved up to this room. The wall facing out to the deck will be glass.

Adoration Chapel: This entire chapel will be rainbow stained-glass, and it will be shaped as a rainbow to symbolize the ending of the flood.

Sacristy: This is the priest's room, which will be quite simple and just wooden all around.



Important Notes

Altar: The altar will be on a platform elevated with rainbow, stain glassed stairs. The altar will be the yellow sun, and it will be elevated. A foot above the head of where a priest would be at the altar, a clear, yellow, glass tube will raise up into the ceiling and travel up to where the yellow sun is at the floor of the Adoration chapel. In this tube, there will be a space that will act as the Tabernacle where the priest may put the Eucharist!

Piano, Paschal Candle: The piano and candle will be on one of three elevated round, stained glass structures and will be the highest on their respective sides.

Band, Baptismal Font: The band and Baptismal font will be on the second highest elevated round, stained glass structures on their respective sides.

Choir, Baptism Standing Area: The choir and Baptism standing area will be on the lowest elevated round, stained glass structures on their respective sides.

Animal Pens and Pews: These are two stories, and each floor has four pens with one pew in them. When you add the number of pews included in the pens with those on the floor, you get forty, just like it rained for 40 days and 40 nights, and just like Jesus was in the desert for that long.

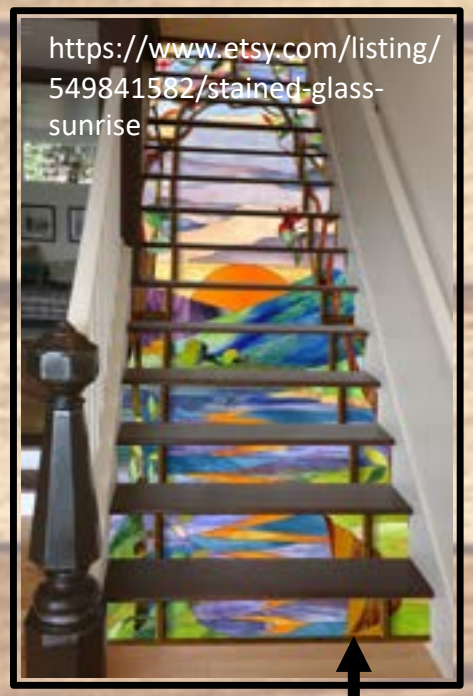
Elevator: The elevator is stained glass rainbow and goes up to the Adoration Chapel and down to the Sacristy and storage.

Stairs: These will be stained glass and will lead both upstairs to the Adoration chapel and downstairs to the Sacristy.


https://www.flickr.com/photos/amsterdamasp/2968827031


https://www.flickr.com/photos/amsterdamasp/2968827031

Inspiration for Animal Pens


https://www.etsy.com/listing/549841582/stained-glass-sunrise

Stair Inspiration
(but the stairs will be rainbow)



Elevator Inspiration
(but it will be stained-glass)


https://cms.esi.info/Media/documents/22989_1583839127422.pdf


https://www.obbligato.co.za/furniture/slatwavebench.htm

Inspiration For Pews



Inspiration for the Tabernacle Space/ Yellow Tube Above the Altar

Floor Inspiration


https://www.archiexpo.com/prod/thinkglass/product-80238-1336559.html



The Altar Space

Adoration Chapel



This is the floor of the Adoration chapel, and this yellow sun is what the yellow glass tube above the priest's altar will lead to. The rest of the chapel is in the rainbow portion of this picture! The pews are in a circular shape, and the monstrance is in the middle! Around the perimeter of the chapel, there will be candles for people to light for their intentions!



Candles will be around the perimeter of the chapel!

The ceiling of the chapel will have curved, wooden bars like those in this picture.



This is the overall image of the chapel from outside of the boat! The front is the same as the back!



The Deck of Reflection



The deck has both an outdoor and indoor section. The outdoor section will have a large fountain in the middle with space for people to walk around and look out at the water. Similarly, people can bring blankets, guitars, rosaries, etc. out and use the space to reflect and pray.

The fountain will be a circular one with a tree in the middle of it and a dove with an olive leaf on top, representing the moment when the dove that Noah sent off found land again for the first time after the flood.

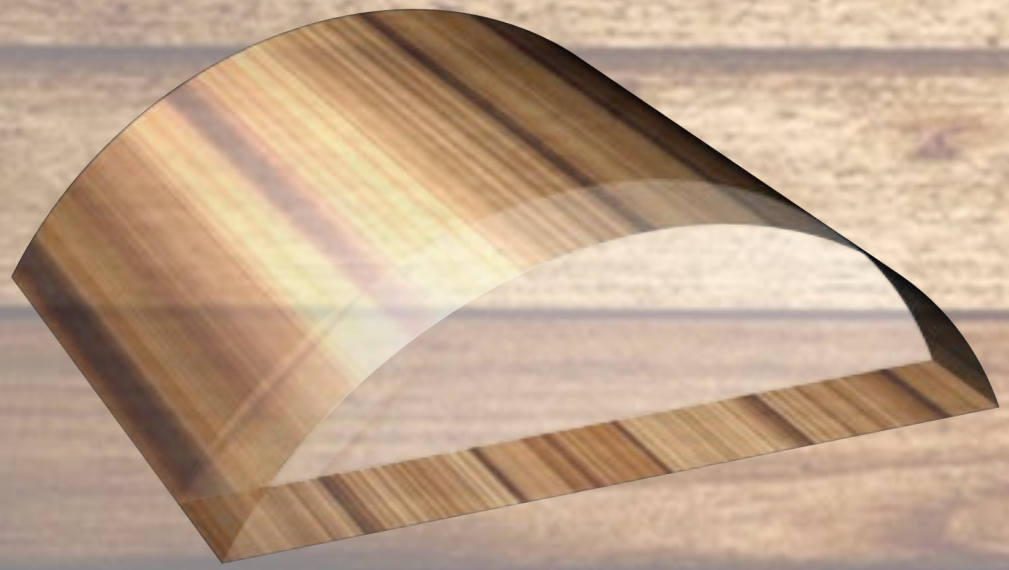






The Deck of Reflection

The Deck of Reflection



The inside portion of the Deck of Reflection will be used as a confessional space as well as an area full of statues centered around Stations of the Cross. The confessionals will be animal pens similar to the ones in the main Church space, but glass will keep the structure together along with the wooden boards show in the pictures below. The pens will be in the back of the room. The Stations of the Cross statues will be on the left and right sides of the room, up against the walls. They will be in this room so that people may reflect on the fact that Jesus died to save us from our sins before they go into confession with a priest. The middle of the room will be filled with pews made of hay for people to relax while they wait for confession. There will be some on the left and right of the room, and those on the right will face those on the left; they will not face towards the confessionals.

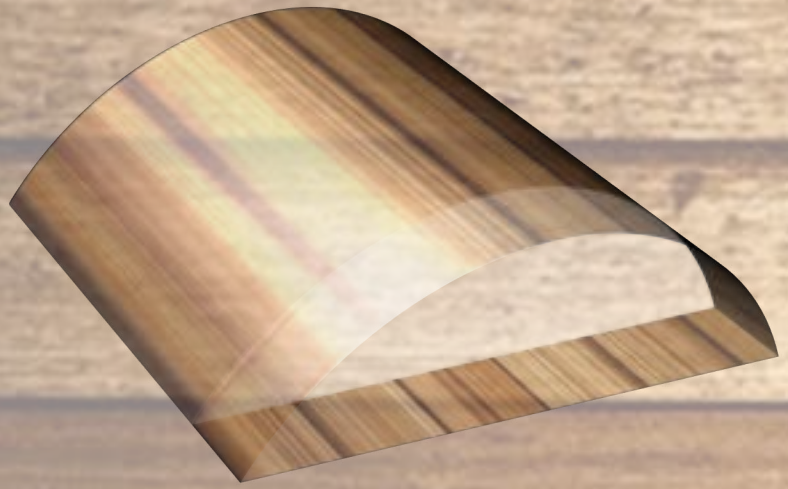

https://www.flickr.com/photos/amsterdamasp/2968827031


https://www.acteonline.org/tech-lab-reno/



https://www.buckminsterbarnandlakeside.co.uk/planning-your-romantic-barn-wedding/

Deck of Community and Education



The Deck of Community and Education will be the least decorated of them all. That is because the space should be easily transformed for classroom necessities or other Church activities. Similar to the Deck of Reflection, there is both an indoor and outdoor area. There should be tables and chairs in the storage section of the bottom of the boat that can be brought up to the second floor for events that are to be held on this deck. Surrounding the outside portion of the deck and facing inwards at visitors will be paintings of animals on the wood. Other than that, though, there will not be too many decorations.





https://www.saatchiart.com/print/New-Media-Animals-of-Noah-s-Ark/1071385/4129522/view



https://www.icanvas.com/canvas-print/noahs-ark-rua112#1PC6-40x26



https://bookshop.org/p/books/fine-art-panoramic-noah-s-ark-1000-pieces-eurographics/16528700?ean=0628136546546





